

Exercises 1A

1. Suppose $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a bounded function such that $L(f, P, [a, b]) = U(f, P, [a, b])$ for some partition P of $[a, b]$. Prove that f is the constant function on $[a, b]$.

Let $a = x_0, \dots, x_n = b$ denote the partition P of $[a, b]$. Since the lower and upper Riemann sums are equal, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j=1}^n (x_j - x_{j-1}) \sup_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f &= \sum_{j=1}^n (x_j - x_{j-1}) \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f. \\ \implies \sum_{j=1}^n (x_j - x_{j-1}) \left(\sup_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f - \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f \right) &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

The length of each interval is strictly positive, and $\sup_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f \geq \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f$ for each j , so the above sum consists of only non-negative terms. Thus, we have $(x_j - x_{j-1}) \left(\sup_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f - \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f \right) = 0$ for each interval, and $\left(\sup_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f = \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f \right)$. Thus, f is constant on every interval $[x_{j-1}, x_j]$.

$f(x) = f(a)$ for every $x \in [x_1, x_2]$. Suppose f is $f(a)$ on an interval $[x_{j-1}, x_j]$. Since f is also constant on the interval $[x_j, x_{j+1}]$, $f(x) = f(x_j) = f(a)$ for all $x \in [x_j, x_{j+1}]$. By mathematical induction, $f(x) = f(a)$ on every interval $[x_j, x_{j+1}]$. Therefore, f is constant on the entire domain. $\square$

2. Suppose that $a \leq s < t \leq b$. Define $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } s < x < t, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Prove that f is Riemann integrable on $[a, b]$ and that $\int_a^b f = t - s$.

Consider the partition P of $[a, b]$ into $n \in \mathbb{N}$ intervals of equal length given by $x_i = a + i \frac{b-a}{n}$. Notice that

$$L(f, P, [a, b]) = \sum_{i=1}^n d \inf_{[x_{i-1}, x_i]} f \geq (\lfloor \frac{n(t-s)}{b-a} \rfloor - 2) \frac{b-a}{n},$$

and similarly

$$U(f, P, [a, b]) = \sum_{i=1}^n d \sup_{[x_{i-1}, x_i]} f \leq \lfloor \frac{n(t-s)}{b-a} \rfloor \frac{b-a}{n}.$$

Then,

$$L(f, [a, b]) \geq \sup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (\lfloor \frac{n(t-s)}{b-a} \rfloor - 2) \frac{b-a}{n} = t - s = \inf_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (\lfloor \frac{n(t-s)}{b-a} \rfloor) \frac{b-a}{n} \geq U(f, [a, b]).$$

But, since $L(f, [a, b]) \leq U(f, [a, b])$ we have $L(f, [a, b]) = U(f, [a, b]) = t - s$, and hence $\int_a^b f = t - s$. $\square$

3. Suppose $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a bounded function. Prove that f is Riemann integrable if and only if for each $\epsilon > 0$ there exists a partition P of $[a, b]$ such that

$$U(f, P, [a, b]) - L(f, P, [a, b]) < \epsilon.$$

($\implies$) Suppose f is Riemann integrable, and let $I := \int_a^b f$. Let $\epsilon > 0$. Since $I = \sup_P L(f, P, [a, b]) = \inf_P U(f, P, [a, b])$, there is a partition P_1 so that $L(f, P_1, [a, b]) > I - \frac{\epsilon}{2}$ and a partition P_2 so that $U(f, P_2, [a, b]) < I + \frac{\epsilon}{2}$. Let P be the partition obtained by taking the union of P_1 and P_2 . Since P is a finer partition than both P_1 and P_2 , we have

$$L(f, P, [a, b]) \geq L(f, P_1, [a, b]) > I - \epsilon/2$$

and

$$U(f, P, [a, b]) \leq U(f, P_2, [a, b]) < I + \epsilon/2.$$

Hence, $|L(f, P, [a, b]) - I| < \epsilon/2$ and $|U(f, P, [a, b]) - I| < \epsilon/2$. By the triangle inequality, we have

$$\begin{aligned} U(f, P, [a, b]) - L(f, P, [a, b]) &= |U(f, P, [a, b]) - L(f, P, [a, b])| \\ &= |U(f, P, [a, b]) - I + I - L(f, P, [a, b])| \\ &\leq |U(f, P, [a, b]) - I| + |I - L(f, P, [a, b])| \\ &< 2(\epsilon/2) = \epsilon, \end{aligned}$$

as desired.

($\impliedby$) Suppose that f is not Riemann integrable. Let $L := L(f, [a, b])$ and $U := U(f, [a, b])$ be the lower and upper Riemann integrals, where $L \neq U$. Since $L(f, P, [a, b]) \leq U(f, P, [a, b])$ for any partition, $L \leq U$. Let $\epsilon := \frac{U-L}{2}$. Then, for any partition P of $[a, b]$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} U(f, P, [a, b]) - L(f, P, [a, b]) &\geq \inf_P U(f, P, [a, b]) - \sup_P L(f, P, [a, b]) \\ &= U - L \\ &> \epsilon. \end{aligned}$$

□

4. Suppose $f, g : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are Riemann integrable. Prove that $f + g$ is Riemann integrable and that $\int_a^b (f + g) = \int_a^b f + \int_a^b g$.

Recall that the infimum of the set of sums of two sets of real numbers is at least the sum of the infimum of the two sets. Then, we have

$$\begin{aligned} L(f + g, [a, b]) &= \sup_P L(f + g, P, [a, b]) \\ &= \sup_P \sum_{j=1}^n (x_j - x_{j-1}) \inf_{[x_{j-1}, x_j]} f + g \end{aligned}$$